ELECTRONICS CORPORATION OF TAMIL NADU LIMITED – ANGADI DIVISION

Tender ID: E-ANGADI-ST-SDC-2026-0034

Tender for Empanelment of Managed Service Providers (MSP) to provide Cloud services from MeitY empaneled CSPs

Pre-bid Queries – Response - I

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Pre-bid Response-I

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
1.	II. TENDER DATA SHEET Pg.10	19.08.2026, 03.00 PM	Request for 10 working day extension to prepare the bid with approvals and coordination with CSPs	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
2.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.14	o) Any Bidder who is blacklisted by ELCOT or any State or Central Government or its agencies shall not be eligible to bid for the Tenders of ELCOT. Bidder shall give an undertaking in this regard.	Bidder shall give an undertaking in this regard to not being blacklisted by State or Central government or its agencies, which can caused material adverse impact in rendering services based on the requirements of this tender.	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
3.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.14	q) In case any show cause notice has been issued by ELCOT for poor performance to any	In case any show cause notice has been issued by ELCOT for poor performance to any of the contractor,	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/c

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		of the bidder, then ELCOT reserves the right to disqualify the bid submitted by such Bidder.	then ELCOT reserves the right to disqualify the bid submitted by such contractor.	larified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
4.	IV. General Conditions - Bid Currency Pg.16	Clause 5 requires prices/payment in INR and exchange-rate risk to be borne by the bidder. Clause 15 requires negotiated prices to remain firm during the contract, including extensions, and no escalation due to foreign exchange. Clause 6(a) states that work orders will be issued after deducting the discount percentage from CSP list prices in INR on the day of issuing the work order. Clause 6(b)	Please clarify that the firm commercial commitment is the quoted discount percentage and managed-services percentage, while the underlying CSP list price for a work order will be the prevailing CSP public INR list price on the work-order date. Please clarify how public list-price changes, foreign exchange, taxes and CSP price reductions/increases will be handled during the contract period.	CSP discount prices would be applied on existing publicly available market price during submission of cost estimate by MSP/CSP for a requirement. Same would be considered during issuance of work order. Kindly refer to corrigendum

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		permits extra discounts for large-scale projects or educational discount. Clause 7(i) requires a customized cost calculator with discount price applied and a public URL for prevailing rates during bid submission.		
5.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.22	h) The negotiated Price shall be kept firm by the Successful Bidder for a period specified in the Tender. The Successful Bidder should keep the Price firm during the period of Contract including period of extensions, if any.	Bidder requests the following modification: h) The negotiated Price shall be kept firm by the Successful Bidder for a period specified in the Tender. The Successful Bidder should keep the Price firm during the period of Contract ~~including period of extensions, if any.~~	Kindly refer to corrigendum

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6.	IV. General conditions of tender 25. Summary Rejection of Bids Pg.27	25. Summary Rejection of Bids b) Unsatisfactory Past Performance in ELCOT Contracts: Any bid submitted by a bidder Contractor in respect of any tender floated by ELCOT, after issuance of a Letter of Award (LoA) or Work Order: i. has failed to supply goods or deliver services, either wholly or partially; or ii. has withdrawn, abandoned, or failed to honour contractual obligations; or iii. has caused termination of contract due to	25. Summary Rejection of Bids b) Unsatisfactory Past Performance in ELCOT Contracts: Any bid submitted by a Contractor in respect of any tender floated by ELCOT, after issuance of a Letter of Award (LoA) or Work Order: i. has failed to supply goods or deliver services, either wholly or partially; or ii. has withdrawn, abandoned, or failed to honour contractual obligations; or iii. has caused termination of contract due to default,	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

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		default, iv. shall be liable for summary rejection for a period up to three (3) years from the date of such LoA/Work Order or for the duration of any restriction or blacklisting imposed by ELCOT, whichever is earlier. c) Blacklisting / Debarment by Government Authorities: Any bid submitted by a bidder Contractor who is under blacklisting, debarment, or business restriction imposed by any Central Government Department, State		

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		Government Department, Government Agency, Statutory Authority, or Public Sector Undertaking (PSU), as on the date of bid submission, shall be liable for rejection during the validity period of such blacklisting or debarment.		
7.	IV. General Conditions 26. Price Bid Evaluation Pg.29	Clause 26(h) states that the successful bidder cannot claim orders from ELCOT as a matter of right. Scope of Work states that Government of Tamil Nadu has announced a Rs. 10 crore Tamil Nadu StartUp Data server services scheme	Please provide the historical aggregate value of work orders, invoices and payments under the previous ELCOT cloud empanelment, with CSP-wise and department-wise breakup if available; current monthly cloud run-rate; number of active workloads;	Around 45 applications are currently being run through the CSP/MSP engaged through last tender.

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		allocation and that startups would use services of empaneled CSPs. Clause 7(d) states invoices must be based on resources actually consumed and committed.	expected migration pipeline; and the expected drawdown schedule for the Rs. 10 crore startup-cloud allocation.	
8.	IV. General Conditions of Tender Pg.29	The Tender Accepting Authority may reject a Tender or the Price offered by a Bidder for an item, if it has determined that the Price Bid/Price in combination with other constituent elements of the Tender is abnormally low or abnormally high in relation to the subject matter of the procurement	While evaluating prices under this clause, the Tender Accepting Authority shall consider the technical architecture, service resilience, infrastructure investments, and equivalent cloud capabilities offered by the CSP. Price comparison shall be made only between technically equivalent solutions	H1/L1 will be ranked within CSPs. MSPs matching the H1/L1 discount/prices will be empaneled.

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		and raises concerns with such authority as to the ability of the Bidder to perform the Contract.		
9.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.31	d) The SD shall be paid by the Successful Bidder within 10 days from the date of issue Letter of Award (LoA) by ELCOT. ELCOT reserves the right to extend the time limit if the reasons on which the extension is sought are deemed fit.	Bidder requests the following modification: d) The SD shall be paid by the Successful Bidder within 30 ~~10~~ days from the date of issue Letter of Award (LoA) by ELCOT. ELCOT reserves the right to extend the time limit if the reasons on which the extension is sought are deemed fit. Request to exempt Government organizations from submitting the Rs 10,00,000/- performance security deposit.	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good. Entities wholly owned by Government are exempted from SD. In such case, EMD paid will be converted to SD. Kindly refer to corrigendum.

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10.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.31	h) The validity of the Bank Guarantee shall be extended by the Successful Bidder for appropriate period at its own motion and at its own cost in case of extension of the Contract.	Bidder requests the following modification: h) The validity of the Bank Guarantee shall be extended by the Successful Bidder for appropriate period at its own motion and at its own cost in case of extension of the Contract on mutually agreed terms and conditions.	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
11.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.32	b) The Successful Bidder should execute a Contract in the INR 100 non judicial Stamp Paper bought in Tamil Nadu only in the name of the Bidder within 15 days from the date of issue of Letter of Award/ within 7 days from the date of receipt of	Bidder requests the following modification: b) The Successful Bidder should execute a Contract in the INR 100 non judicial Stamp Paper bought in Tamil Nadu only in the name of the Bidder within 30 ~~15~~ days from the date of issue of Letter of Award/ within 21 ~~7~~ days from the date of	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

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		SD, whichever is earlier.	receipt of SD, whichever is earlier.	
12.	IV. General Conditions 33. Limitation of Liability Pg.33	Clause 32 states ELCOT is not liable for losses or damages to the Contractor due to delay at End User side. Clause 37 permits withholding and recovery from payables. Clause 6(a) states work orders will be issued to empaneled service providers based on CSP list prices minus discount. Clause 7 requires invoicing to concerned Government departments, payment on monthly basis, invoices based on actual and committed	Please specify the invoice approval process, payment due date, deemed acceptance period, treatment of disputed versus undisputed amounts, and responsibility for payment delays by individual departments. Please confirm whether the bidder may suspend or restrict services for non-payment after notice, and how CSP payment obligations will be handled where department payments are delayed.	Work order to successful bidder would be issued by Department and invoices would be raised by successful bidder directly to end user department as per ELCOT SOP.

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		resources, no advance payment, no interest on delayed payments beyond department control, and deduction of taxes.		
13.	IV. General conditions of tender 33. Limitation of Liability Pg.33	Liability of ELCOT a) ELCOT shall not be liable to the Contractor for any losses or damages, costs, charges which the Contractor may in any way sustain/suffer due to any delay at the End User side.	a) ELCOT shall not be liable to the Contractor for any indirect or consequential losses or damages, costs, charges which the Contractor may in any way sustain/suffer due to any delay at the End User side. However, Contractor shall be excused and not be liable or responsible for any delay or failure to perform the services or failure of the services or a deliverable under this tender, to the extent that such delay or	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

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			failure has arisen as a result of any delay or failure by the ELCOT or its employees or agents or third party service providers to perform any of its duties and obligations as set out in this tender. In the event that Contractor is delayed or prevented from performing its obligations due to such failure or delay on the part of or on behalf of the ELCOT, then Contractor shall be allowed an additional period of time to perform its obligations and unless otherwise agreed the additional period shall be equal to the amount of time for which Contractor is delayed or prevented	

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			from performing its obligations due to such failure or delay on the part of or on behalf of the ELCOT. Such failures or delays shall be are brought to the notice of the ELCOT and subject to mutual agreement with the ELCOT, then Contractor shall take such actions as may be necessary to correct or remedy the failures or delays. Contractor shall be entitled to invoice the ELCOT for additional costs incurred in connection with correction or remedy as above at time & material rate card as agreed upon between the parties.	

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14.	IV. General conditions of tender 33. Limitation of Liability Pg.33	a) In the case of Gross negligence or willful misconduct on the part of the Contractor executing the work or in carrying out the services, the Contractor, with respect to damage including to property and/or Assets/Sales/Revenue of ELCOT/End User shall regardless of anything contained herein, shall be liable for any direct loss or damage that is less than or equal to (A) the Total Contract Value of the Contract or (B) the proceeds the Contractor may be entitled to receive	IV. GENERAL CONDITIONS OF TENDER 33. Limitation of Liability a) In the case of Gross negligence or willful misconduct on the part of the Contractor executing the work or in carrying out the services, the Contractor, with respect to damage including to property and/or Assets/Sales/Revenue of ELCOT/End User shall regardless of anything contained herein, shall be liable for any direct loss or damage which shall not exceed the total amount paid to Contractor by ELCOT in the preceding twelve	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

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		from any insurance maintained by the Contractor, to cover such a liability, whichever of (A) or (B) is higher. b) There shall be no limitation of liability in respect of the Contractor in case of any damages for bodily injury (including death) and damage to real property and tangible personal property, other than as applicable under the relevant laws. c) The Contract does not grant or create any rights, benefits, claims, obligations or causes of action in, to or on behalf of	months under that applicable work that gives rise to such liability as of the date the liability arose. that is less than or equal to (A) the Total Contract Value of the Contract or (B) the proceeds the Contractor may be entitled to receive from any insurance maintained by the Contractor, to cover such a liability, whichever of (A) or (B) is higher. b) There shall be no limitation of liability in respect of the Contractor in case of any damages for bodily injury (including death) and damage to real property and tangible personal	

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		any person or entity (including any third party) other than between the respective parties to the Contract, as the case may be. d) ELCOT/End User shall be entitled to claim the remedy of specific performance under the Contract. This right to claim for any damage shall be without prejudice to other rights and remedies available to ELCOT/End User under the Contract and law. e) ELCOT/End User shall be entitled without prejudice to its other rights and remedies, to deduct from the Price	property, other than as applicable under the relevant laws. c) The Contract does not grant or create any rights, benefits, claims, obligations or causes of action in, to or on behalf of any person or entity (including any third party) other than between the respective parties to the Contract, as the case may be. d) ELCOT/End User shall be entitled to claim the remedy of specific performance under the Contract. This right to claim for any damage shall be without prejudice to other rights and	

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		payable to Contractor and also to encash the Bank Guarantee for Security Deposit or any other Bank Guarantee, provided the total amount recovered does not exceed the Total Contract Value or the insurance cover, whichever is higher.	remedies available to ELCOT/End User under the Contract and law. e) ELCOT/End User shall be entitled without prejudice to its other rights and remedies, to deduct from the Price payable to Contractor and also to encash the Bank Guarantee for Security Deposit or any other Bank Guarantee, provided the total amount recovered does not exceed the Total Contract Value or the insurance cover, whichever is higher. f) Notwithstanding anything to contained in this Tender or under any other document, neither party shall be	

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			liable to the other for any special, indirect, incidental, consequential (including loss of profit or revenue, loss of data), exemplary or punitive damages whether in contract, tort or other theories of law, even if such party has been advised of the possibility of such damages.	
15.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.33	33. Limitation of Liability	The aggregate liability of bidder (whether in contract, tort, negligence, strict liability in tort, by statute or otherwise) for any claim in any manner related to this Agreement, including the work, deliverables or Services covered by this Agreement, shall be the payment of	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

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			direct damages only which shall in no event exceed the total amount, paid to bidder by the Purchaser in the preceding twelve months under this Agreement that gives rise to such liability (as of the date the liability arose). In no event shall bidder be liable for any consequential, incidental, indirect, special or punitive damage, loss or expenses (including but not limited to business interruption, lost business, lost profits, or lost savings) nor for any third-party claims (other than those set-forth in Clause (i) above) even if it has been advised	

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			of their possible existence.	
16.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.34	34. Assigning of Tender whole or in part a) The Contractor shall not assign or make over the Contract, the benefit or burden thereof to any other person or persons or body corporate for the execution of the Contract or any part thereof. b) ELCOT/End User reserves its right to cancel the LoA either in part or full, if this condition is violated.	34. Assigning of Tender whole or in part a) Neither Party shall be entitled to assign or transfer all or any of its rights, benefits and obligations under this proposal without the prior written consent of the other Party. b) ELCOT/End User reserves its right to cancel the LoA either in part or full, if this condition is violated.	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
17.	IV. General conditions of tender	The Contractor shall indemnify and defend ELCOT/End User and its	Third Party claim against ELCOT that any Deliverables/Services	Tender condition, as amended by latest

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	35. Indemnity Pg.34	representatives & employees and hold ELCOT/End User, its representatives, employees harmless from a) Damages and losses to persons or property caused by Contractor's negligent or intentional act. b) Damages and losses to persons or property resulting from the non compliance with the established obligations; Third Party claim against ELCOT/End User that any Deliverables/Services/Equipment provided by the Contractor infringes a copyright, trade	provided by the Contractor infringes a copyright, trade secret, patents or other intellectual property rights of any third party, in which case the Contractor shall defend such claim at its expense and shall pay any costs or damages that may be finally awarded against ELCOT c) If any deliverable is or likely to be held to be infringing, the Contractor shall at its expense and option either (i) procure the right for End User to continue using it, or (ii) replace it with a non-infringing equivalent, or (iii) modify it to make it non-infringing. If none	corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

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		secret, patents or other intellectual property rights of any third party, in which case the Contractor shall defend such claim at its expense and shall pay any costs or damages that may be finally awarded against ELCOT/End User. c) If any deliverable is or likely to be held to be infringing, the Contractor shall at its expense and option either (i) procure the right for End User to continue using it, or (ii) replace it with a non-infringing equivalent, or (iii) modify it to make it non-infringing.	of the above alternatives are reasonably available, Contractor shall refund the fees paid by ELCOT for the infringing deliverable and ELCOT shall cease using such deliverable. Contractor shall have no obligations with respect to any third – party IPR infringement claims to the extent that the infringement claim arises or results from: (i) Contractor's compliance with ELCOT's specific technical designs or instructions; (ii) inclusion in a Deliverable of any content or other materials provided by ELCOT and the infringement relates to	

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		d) Any environmental damages caused by Contractor e) Any and all claims, actions, suits, proceedings, taxes, duties, levies, costs, expenses, damages and liabilities, including attorneys' fees, arising out of, connected with, or resulting from or arising in connections with the services provided by the Contractor due to neglect, omission or intentional act of the Contractor.	or arises from such ELCOT provided material; (iii) modification of a Deliverable after delivery by Contractor to ELCOT if such modification was not made by or on behalf of the Contractor; or (iv) use of the Deliverable in combination with products not provided by Contractor or otherwise not contemplated in the applicable specifications or documentation. g) ELCOT warrants that all software, information, data, materials and other assistance provided by it under this proposal shall not infringe any	

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			intellectual property rights of third parties, and agrees that it shall at all times indemnify and hold Contractor harmless from any loss, claim, damages, costs, expenses, including Attorney's fees, which may be incurred as a result of any action or claim that may be made or initiated against it by any third parties alleging infringement of their rights.	
18.	IV. General Conditions of Tender Pg.36	Inspect the Bidder's Data Center before Opening of the Price Bid.	Inspection of the bidder's Data Center may be carried out either through a physical visit or by accepting valid third-party certifications, audit reports, and compliance attestations (such as	Physical visit is optional and would be done as required, within the security limits of CSPs.

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			ISO 27001, SOC, PCI DSS, TIA-942, Uptime Institute, or equivalent internationally recognized certifications) where physical access is restricted due to security and operational policies.	
19.	IV. General Conditions of Tender Pg.36	Clause 42.C: ELCOT may terminate for convenience with 30 days notice. Part A/C: Bidders quote for 1-year and 3-year Reserved Instances (RI).	Financial Protection on Reserved Instances: If a user department orders a 1-year or 3-year Reserved Instance and ELCOT/Department terminates the order early under Clause 42.C, will ELCOT/Department reimburse the unexpired financial commitment fee charged by the CSP?	In case of such termination for convenience, payment wll be made till the services are migrated other empaneled CSP or for a maximum of 2 months, whichever is earlier.

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20.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg. 37	h) Recover from any payable to the Contractor irrespective of Contract.	Bidder requests that this clause be deleted	Clause stands deleted.
21.	IV. General Conditions of Tender 41. Validity and Extension of Contract Pg.38	The Tender invites bids for empanelment of MSPs to provide cloud services from MeitY-empaneled CSPs. Clause 6 provides for work orders to empaneled service providers. Clause 41 and Annexure 1 state that the contract is valid for the specified/12-month period and may be extended by mutual agreement. The Tender does not expressly state whether this empanelment will	Please clarify whether this Tender, upon finalization, is intended to replace/supersede the existing/current rate contract for cloud/data-center services, or whether the existing rate contract will continue until its natural expiry. Please also confirm whether renewal/extension of the current rate contract will be stopped after this Tender is awarded, and whether existing work orders under the current rate contract will continue	That is purely a matter of that tender and agreement, and has nothing to do with this tender process.

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		replace the current cloud/data-center rate contract or affect renewal of the current rate contract.	unaffected until completion or will be transitioned to the new empanelment.	
22.	IV. General conditions of tender 39. Confidentiality Pg.38	d) The Bidder shall be liable to fully recompense ELCOT for any loss of revenue arising from breach of confidentiality. ELCOT reserves the right to adopt legal proceedings, civil or criminal, against the Bidder in relation to a dispute arising out of breach of obligation by the Bidder under this clause.	Loss of revenue is an indirect or consequential damage which is not acceptable proposition. Mutual confidential obligations missing.	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
23.	IV. General conditions of tender	a) ELCOT may without prejudice to any other remedy for breach of	a) ELCOT may without prejudice to any other remedy for breach of Contract, by written	Tender condition, as amended by latest

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	42. Termination of Contract A. Termination for default Pg.39	Contract, by written notice of default with a period of 7 days, sent to the Contractor, terminate the Contract in whole or part i) if the Contractor fails to deliver any or all of the goods within the time period specified in the Contract or within any extension thereof granted by ELCOT; or ii) If the Contractor fails to perform any of the obligation under the Contract; or iii) If the Contractor, in the judgement of ELCOT, has engaged in fraudulent and corrupt practices in	notice of default and not cured within a period of 307 days, sent to the Contractor, terminate the Contract in whole or part i) if the Contractor fails to deliver any or all of the deliverables or services goods within the time period specified in the Contract or within any extension thereof granted by ELCOT; or ii) If the Contractor fails to perform any of the obligation under the Contract; or iii) If the Contractor, in the judgement of ELCOT, has engaged in fraudulent and corrupt practices in competing for or in executing the Contract or …	corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

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		competing for or in executing the Contract or …		
24.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.39	b) In the event ELCOT terminates the Contract in whole or in part, ELCOT may procure, upon terms and in such manner as it deems appropriate, the goods and services similar to those and delivered and the Contractor shall be liable to ELCOT for any additional costs for such similar goods. However, the Contractor shall continue the performance of the Contract to the extent not terminated.	Bidder requests the following addition: b) In the event ELCOT terminates the Contract in whole or in part, ELCOT may procure, upon terms and in such manner as it deems appropriate, the goods and services similar to those and delivered and the Contractor shall be liable to ELCOT for any additional costs for such similar goods. However, the Contractor shall continue the performance of the Contract to the extent not terminated. The cost of procurement	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

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			from alternate source shall be capped to value of goods/services not delivered as established in the contract.	
25.	IV. General Conditions of Tender C. Termination for Convenience Pg.40	ELCOT may, at any time, by written notice of not less than 30 (thirty) days to the Contractor, terminate the Contract, in whole or in part, for ELCOT's convenience. The notice of termination shall specify the extent to which performance of work under the Contract is terminated and the effective date of termination.	Request to delete the clause	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
26.	IV. General conditions of tender	C. Termination for Convenience	Bidder requests that this clause be deleted	Tender condition, as amended by

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	A. Termination for Convenience Pg.40			latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
27.	IV. General conditions of tender Pg.40	C. Termination for Convenience	Bidder requests the following addition: Either party may by written notice with a notice period of 90 days sent to the other, may terminate the Contract, in whole or in part, at any time for its convenience. The notice of termination shall specify the extent to which performance of work under the Contract is terminated, and the date upon which such termination becomes effective. On termination, the bidder is entitled to	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

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			compensation against all the services rendered, material delivered, advances paid and all such costs that have been incurred by the bidder to provide services as per the agreement.	
28.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 1. Scope of Work Pg.43	Also, Government of Tamil Nadu has announced a scheme to provide vouchers for availing data center services to startups registered with iTNT and StartUp TN. This will be implemented by ELCOT through the 'Tamil Nadu StartUp Data server services scheme' at an allocation of Rs. 10 crores. These startups would also utilize	ELCOT may define the operational framework for the Startup Data Server Services Scheme, including the process for voucher issuance, utilization, audit, reimbursement timelines, treatment of voucher exhaustion, and compensation for onboarding and managing startup beneficiaries. A one-time onboarding/administrative fee for each startup may also be	CSPs/MSPs would offer the service to StartUps in the same model as done for Govt departments. The voucher scheme will be handled by ELCOT with startups in a reimbursement model.

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		the services of empaneled cloud service providers.	considered to offset the operational effort involved in managing the startup ecosystem.	
29.	V. Tender Specific Conditions – 2. Bidder Eligibility Criteria Pg.44	Eligibility S.No. 2 requires the bidder to be a CSP or MSP/authorized partner of a CSP, with the CSP empaneled by MeitY, and requires the MeitY empanelment certificate and CSP authorization certificate. S.No. 3 requires the authorized partner to have been partner to the CSP for at least one year as on the tender publication date. Annexure 7 requires signature of the CSP for offered MeitY-	Please prescribe or confirm the acceptable format and content of the CSP authorization letter, including whether it must identify the bidder, CSP, MeitY-empaneled data centers, service categories, date of commencement of partnership, bid validity, work-order validity and right to quote through the partner. Please confirm that the CSP authorization will be considered valid for all active work orders issued under this tender.	CSP may provide authorization letter including the name of MSP being authorized, CSP, MeitY empaneled data center, service category, validity of MeitY empanelment, date of commencement of partnership with MSP.

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		empaneled cloud service offerings.		
30.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 2. Bidder Eligibility Pg.44	Bidder shall be CSP or MSP.	Kindly clarify whether an MSP bidding with an authorized MeitY empaneled CSP is required to submit an OEM authorization letter in addition to the MeitY empanelment certificate.	MSP shall submit CSP authorization letter for providing CSP cloud services.
31.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 2. Bidder Eligibility Criteria Pg.45	If the Bidder is an authorized partner of CSP empaneled with MeitY, then the bidder should have minimum average annual turnover of at least Rs.10 Crore in any two of last five financial years i.e., 2020-21, 2021-22, 2022-23, 2023-24 & 2024-25 from DC or Cloud business.	For DPIIT-recognized Startups and MSMEs acting as authorized partners of MeitY-empaneled CSPs, bidders may be permitted to demonstrate financial eligibility based on the audited financial statements available since incorporation, subject to a minimum of three financial years, instead of the	Tender asks for average turnover for at least 2 years in any of the last five years.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			prescribed five-year assessment period.	
32.	Chapter V: Tender Specific conditions 2. Bidder Eligibility Criteria Pg.45	If the bidder is an authorized partner of a CSP empaneled with MeitY, then the bidder should have been a partner to the CSP for at least 1 year as on date of publishing of this tender.	Request to change the clause to If the bidder is an authorized partner of a CSP empaneled with MeitY, then the bidder should have been a partner to the CSP for atleast 6 months as on date of publishing of this tender.	Kindly refer to corrigendum.
33.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 2. Bidder Eligibility Criteria Pg. 45	The bidder shall be CSP or MSP (authorized partner of CSP). In either case, CSP shall be empaneled with MeitY for providing cloud services.	Could be considered CSP/MSP of MeitY attached organization who is in the process obtaining MeitY empanelment certificate.	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
34.	V. Tender Specific Conditions	If the Bidder is an authorized partner of CSP empaneled with MeitY, then the bidder should have	We request you to kindly amend the clause as follows: If the Bidder is an authorized partner of	Kindly refer to corrigendum

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	2. Bidder Eligibility Criteria Pg. 45	minimum average annual turnover of at least Rs.10 Crore in any two of last five financial years i.e., 2020-21, 2021-22, 2022-23, 2023-24 & 2024-25 from DC or Cloud business. If the Bidder is a MeitY empaneled CSP / Government institutions under MeitY, then this turnover criterion shall not apply.	CSP empaneled with MeitY, then the bidder should have minimum average annual turnover of at least Rs.10 Crore in any two of last five financial years i.e.,**2021-22, 2022-23, 2023-24, 2024-25 & 2025-26** from DC or Cloud business. If the Bidder is a MeitY empaneled CSP / Government institutions under MeitY, then this turnover criterion shall not apply.	
35.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 2. Bidder Eligibility Criteria Pg.46	The bidder must have a full-fledged operational office in Chennai or should provide an undertaking that a full-fledged full-time office will be setup in	Request to please amend the criteria to - The bidder must have a full-fledged operational office in the State (Tamil Nadu) or should provide an	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		Chennai within 30 days of empanelment	undertaking that a full-fledged full-time office will be setup in the State (Tamil Nadu) within 30 days of empanelment	reply, stands good.
36.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 2. Bidder Eligibility Criteria Pg. 46	a) In case of Authorised Signatory submitting bid documents, Power of Attorney (PoA) shall be issued to the Authorized Signatory of Bidder to sign and submit the bid, execute the Contract Agreement on behalf of the Bidder firm, to be issued by the Board of Directors/ the Managing Director of the Company.	Bidder requests the following: Please accept Power of Attorney in the bidder's own format	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
37.	V. Tender Specific Conditions	The bidder shall have a full-fledged operational office in	In addition to this, consider the following term "the bidder's	Tender condition, as amended by

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	2. Bidder Eligibility Criteria Pg. 46	Chennai or should provide an undertaking that a full-fledged full-time office will be setup in Chennai within 30 days of empanelment	DC/DR should be in Chennai and operate in a Govt. organization's own building.	latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
38.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.47	The mandatory pre-requisite states that only CSPs currently empaneled with MeitY and CSP services/data centers empaneled with MeitY are eligible. Clause 3.1(a) applies CSP MeitY terms. Clause 3.1(b) requires hosting only in MeitY-empaneled CSP data centers and data residency in India. Clause 6(d) states termination of empanelment	Please confirm that renewal of CSP MeitY empanelment or partner authorization during the contract period will not automatically terminate existing work orders, provided renewal is in process or completed within a reasonable cure period. Please confirm whether active work orders may continue where the CSP and data-center location remain compliant at service level.	A valid MeitY empanelment is mandatory for participation as well as for empanelment.



S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		automatically terminates or expires all work orders. Clause 8(c) permits termination in case of change of accreditation, lower accreditation or losing partnership.		
39.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.47	Clause 37(a) reserves the right to inspect the bidder data center before opening the price bid. Clause 3.1(b) requires hosting in MeitY-empaneled CSP data-center locations and India data residency.	Please confirm that, for shared public-cloud data centers of a MeitY-empaneled CSP, physical inspection by ELCOT/End User may be substituted by MeitY/STQC empanelment evidence, ISO/SOC/compliance reports, audit certificates and other CSP standard assurance documentation.	Physical visit is optional and would be done as required, within the security limits of CSPs.
40.	V. Tender Specific	It should be possible to scale the solution	Kindly clarify whether the requirement for	CSP/MSP shall have provision

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.47	horizontally at any time by adding more VMs of the same configuration without prior notification to the CSP or their authorized partner, it should be possible to automate this process of scaling up and down automatically.	automatic horizontal scaling (automatic scale-out/scale-in of VMs without prior notification) is mandatory for all workloads deployed under this tender or is to be implemented on a case-by-case basis depending on the application architecture, workload characteristics, and the requirements of the respective Government Department.	to do so. Applicability would be based on the end user department request.
41.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.47	"All terms and conditions of the CSP's empanelment with MeitY are automatically applicable to this tender"	Can ELCOT clarify which specific version/version constraints of MeitY empanelment guidelines apply? Are there any grandfather clauses for existing empaneled CSPs?	The extant guidelines of MeitY shall applicable.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
42.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.47	"Both DR and DC sites should lie within India in different seismic zones or at the minimum distance of 300 kms"	Should the 300 km distance apply if both sites are already in different seismic zones as per Indian Meteorological Department classification?	Tender condition is clear and allows either or option.
43.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.47	"It should be possible to scale the solution horizontally by adding more VMs without prior notification to the CSP"	How should the CSP handle situations where scaling hits regional capacity limits or when auto-scaling is triggered during load spikes? What is the maximum burst capacity expected?	CSP can have their upper limits. However feature should be available.
44.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg.47	All terms and conditions of the CSP's MeitY empanelment are automatically applicable.	Kindly confirm whether a bidder offering services through a MeitY empaneled CSP is required to comply only with the applicable MeitY empanelment conditions for the subscribed cloud	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/ clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			services or whether any additional compliance documentation is expected during empanelment.	
45.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg.47	Servers shall be hosted only in MeitY empaneled DCs.	Kindly clarify whether documentary evidence of MeitY empanelment of the proposed Data Centre and DR site is sufficient at the time of bidding.	Yes.
46.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg.47	DC and DR shall be in different seismic zones or minimum 300 km apart.	Kindly clarify whether compliance with either condition (different seismic zones **or** minimum 300 km separation) is acceptable.	Yes. Tender condition is clear. It is an either-or clause.
47.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg.47	CSP shall provide interoperability and data portability.	Kindly clarify whether interoperability through standard VM formats, APIs and export/import tools shall be considered compliant, or whether	Yes. Equivalent or higher can be proposed.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			specific interoperability standards are expected.	
48.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.48	Clause 3.1(i) states that the proposed CSP should have capability to integrate with unified platform to provide a holistic view of applications deployed across CSPs.	Please identify the unified platform referred to in Clause 3.1(i), including integration method, API/logging/metrics requirements, data model, security approvals, ownership of licenses and implementation scope. Please confirm that exposing CSP standard APIs, logs, metrics, events and supported connectors is sufficient for compliance, and that any custom integration, third-party license, SIEM connector or professional service effort will be	ELCOT may manage all the CSPs cloud through a single multi cloud platform to support monitoring of VMs, etc. In this case, selected CSPs should provide required technical support.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			separately ordered and priced.	
49.	Chapter V: Tender Specific conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg.48	The bidder must initiate the services within 24 hours of placing the work order and provision the resources within 72 hours from issuance of work order. A penalty of 0.25% of first month invoice shall be applicable for delay of provision of resources for delay in each day	It is requested to provide a timeline of 7 working days for implementing and provisioning the resources. For complex workloads requiring security assessments or custom configurations, can the 72-hour timeline be extended with mutual agreement? What constitutes "provisioning complete"?	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good. Provisioning means the infrastructure availability for end user to host the application. Exclusion available for end user delay.
50.	V. Tender Specific Conditions	CSP should integrate with a unified platform	Please specify the unified platform, integration protocol/API, data	ELCOT may manage all the CSPs cloud through a

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	3. Technical Specifications Pg.48	providing a holistic view across CSPs.	fields, frequency, security requirements and responsibility for connector/licence cost.	single multi cloud platform to support monitoring of VMs, etc. In this case, selected CSPs should provide required technical support.
51.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.48	"In case of hosting applications with payment gateway integration, Department shall insist and CSP shall submit PCI DSS compliance Certificate"	Should the CSP maintain separate dedicated infrastructure for PCI DSS workloads, or is logical segregation with multi-tenancy acceptable per MeitY guidelines?	CSP may provide the infrastructure as per MeitY guidelines
52.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.48	"CSP shall create and maintain Helpdesk/telephonic number and email-based ticketing system"	Should the CSP maintain independent ticketing or integrate with ELCOT's existing ticketing system? Are there API	CSP can use their existing ticketing system and integrate the same with ELCOT

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			specifications for integration?	ticketing tool as required.
53.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.48	"Bidder shall provide escalation matrix reachable 24 x 7 x 365 basis"	Should escalation matrix include regional support teams or global support teams? Are language preferences (English/Tamil) specified for support?	Local support team with good Tamil & English knowledge is preferred.
54.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.48	"Proposed CSP should have capability to integrate with unified platform to provide holistic view of applications deployed across CSPs"	Which unified platform is being referred to? Does ELCOT provide API specifications or documentation?	ELCOT may manage all the CSPs cloud through a single multi cloud platform to support monitoring of VMs, etc. In this case, selected CSPs should provide required technical support.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
55.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.48	"Monitoring tools shall not capture or send Government data to any other establishment over Cloud"	Should CSP restrict telemetry data, logs, and metadata sharing to CSP's own infrastructure? Does this apply to third-party monitoring SaaS solutions (e.g., Datadog, New Relic)?	Monitoring tools may collect only the minimum telemetry required for monitoring and troubleshooting. Such telemetry shall remain within India and within the approved MeitY-empaneled CSP environment. Government application data, database contents, files, payloads, credentials, personal data and sensitive

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
				information shall not be transmitted to any third-party establishment
56.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.48	"Ownership of Data and application shall be of the Departments. Departments can ask for full copies at any time"	What is the expected format and timeline for data extraction? Should CSP provide APIs or bulk export tools? Are retrieval costs applicable for archival data?	The format and timeline for data extraction shall be determined based on the nature, volume, storage class and technical characteristics of the data and shall be specified in the respective work order/Exit Management Plan.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
				The bidder/CSP shall provide suitable self-service APIs, command-line utilities, portal-based bulk export facilities and, wherever required, export through encrypted offline physical storage devices
57.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.48	"Bidder shall provide complete inter-operability support including APIs, data portability, application portability in case ELCOT changes CSP"	What is the scope of "inter-operability support" - does it include data migration, architectural re-design, or just API documentation?	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
58.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.48	"All products/services must be genuine and comply to OEM licensing policy"	Should CSP be responsible for license compliance verification, or does Department warrant license validity?	Yes. For all the infrastructure being procured by end user department from CSP.
59.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.48	"Helpdesk/telephonic number and email-based ticketing system that will resolve problems and answer queries"	Should ticketing system support multiple communication channels (WhatsApp, Teams, Slack) or only email/phone?	Basic requirement is provided. Features can be per CSP.
60.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg. 48	Monitoring tools shall not capture Government data externally.	Kindly clarify whether SaaS-based monitoring platforms are permitted provided Government workload data remains within India and monitoring metadata complies with the stated data residency requirements.	Monitoring tools may collect only the minimum telemetry required for monitoring and troubleshooting. Such telemetry shall remain within India and

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
				within the approved MeitY-empaneled CSP environment. Government application data, database contents, files, payloads, credentials, personal data and sensitive information shall not be transmitted to any third-party establishment
61.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg.49	Advance or post-implementation alerts should be provided for scaling.	Please define required alert channels, recipients, threshold configuration.	CSP/MSP may provide their native thresholds

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
62.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.49	Clause 3.1(r) states that where a MeitY-empaneled CSP proposes solutions through authorized partners, the CSP can authorize multiple partners, but each authorized partner should participate with only a single CSP. Clause 5(b) repeats the one-CSP restriction. Clause 5(d) states that ELCOT will empanel the CSPs or only one authorized partner of each CSP. Clauses 5(k) and 5(l) state that bidder(s) willing to match the H1 discount and L1 managed-service percentage for a	Please reconcile these provisions and confirm whether, for a particular CSP, ELCOT will empanel only one partner or multiple partners who match H1/L1.	Following is clarified: 1. MeitY empaneled CSP can directly participate. 2. MeitY empaneled CSP can authorize one or more MSPs to participate. 3. One MSP can bid for one CSP only. 4. In case of multiple MSPs participate for single CSP; then MSPs matching L1/H1 would be empaneled as well. 5. Price matching

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		particular CSP would be empaneled.		across CSPs is not mandatory.
63.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.49	In case the Government Department, does not have skilled resources or expertise to migrate to cloud or manage the provisioned environment, the Government Department can avail the managed services from the bidder/ CSP which is a part of this tender.	Kindly clarify whether Cloud Migration Services form part of the Managed Services under this tender or are to be procured separately, as Clause 3.4 states that Migration Services are excluded from the scope of Managed Services.	BoQ 1 captures the discount % for each of infrastructure category like compute, storage, etc. BoQ 3 capture item wise cost for each of infrastructure category like compute, storage, etc. BoQ 2 captures Managed services. This cost would be over and above the infrastructure resources

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
				availed by the end user and this is to manage the infrastructure procured through BoQ 1 or BoQ 3. Migration cost is not part of managed services and separate cost is being captured for Migration services.
64.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.49	"No data shall be shared with any Third Party without written approval unless legally required"	Should CSP be bound by this clause for sub-contractors, OEM vendors, or log aggregation services?	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.



S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
65.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.49	"Prior Intimation (at least 15 days) for scheduled maintenance of servers"	Should the 15-day notice apply to emergency security patches or zero-day vulnerability fixes? Are there exceptions for critical infrastructure updates?	Not applicable for emergency security patches or zero-day vulnerability fixes
66.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.50	The Disaster Recovery clause states that the CSP shall provide business continuity and DR services to meet RPO/RTO. It states that charges shall include the cost of VM for replication tool, storage, agent cost for replication, connectivity between DC and DR and any other requirement to get functional DR. Annexure 9 Part C contains DR as a	Please clarify that DR will be scoped and priced per workload based on the ordered RPO/RTO, DR architecture and services selected by the department. Please remove or define the phrase "any other requirement to get functional DR" and confirm that cross-region replication, storage, standby compute, agent/tool licenses, connectivity, VPN/FastConnect/MPLS, egress/data transfer	As per CSP nomenclature. However, CSP has to provide clarification on units (per GB/ per VM, etc) as part of bid.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		service line items per GB and per VM.	and managed operations may be charged separately under the relevant line items where applicable.	
67.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.50	Section 3.3 states that Disaster Recovery charges shall include the cost of VM for running replication tool, storage, agent cost for replication, connectivity between DC and DR and other requirements for functional DR. Annexure 9 Part C S.No. 78 lists "Disaster Recovery as a service" with unit "Per VM" but does not specify the VM configuration or assumptions.	Please provide the required specification and pricing assumptions for Part C S.No. 78, including the VM vCPU/OCPU, RAM, boot/additional storage, operating system, replication tool/agent, active or standby state, RPO/RTO assumption, region/availability-domain assumption, connectivity requirement and whether the rate is monthly or event-based. Alternatively, please allow bidders to quote DR per VM based	Bidder may provide the cost/tech spec as per the public price model and provide clarification as part of the bid.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			on the actual source VM/equivalent target VM configuration ordered by the Department.	
68.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg.50	DR shall meet Department-defined RPO/RTO; DR shall scale up without performance impact	Please specify baseline DR topology, minimum RPO/RTO, replication mode, test frequency, failover/failback responsibility and DR drill acceptance criteria.	CSP/MSP may have the required features. Required metrics will be finalized as per end user requirements.
69.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.50	"Charges include cost of VM for replication tool, storage, agent cost for replication, connectivity between DC & DR"	Should "connectivity cost" include only CSP-provided connectivity or also Department's inter-site networking?	Department inter-site networking is not included.
70.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification	"Charges incurred during time of availing DR will be paid as per resources	During DR activation, should the Department continue paying for the primary DC resources or only DR resources?	DC resources payment would be as per SLA.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	Pg.50	provisioned as per unit pricing"		
71.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.51	In case the Government Department, does not have expertise to manage the provisioned cloud services, the Government Department can procure the cloud managed services (e.g., provisioning, security configuration, monitoring) from the bidder. The categories compute, DR, DB as a service, backup, network, storage, security, monitoring, support service & migration	Kindly clarify whether Cloud Managed Services are optional and applicable only where the Government Department lacks the required cloud management expertise, or whether Managed Services are to be provided by the bidder for all projects under this tender irrespective of the Department's in-house cloud management capabilities.	Cloud Managed Service is optional for end user to choose. Please refer the scope of Cloud manager service in Clause 3.5 Cloud Managed Services

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		are to be quoted mandatorily for bid submission		
72.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3.4 Migration Services Pg.51	"Define resource requirement and Security Architecture for Cloud"	Should CSP bear cost of security assessment tools (e.g., penetration testing, compliance scanning) during migration planning?	CSP may provide cost component for items in BoQ or financial bid.pdf
73.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg.51	Cloud Managed Services	Kindly clarify whether managed services may be delivered remotely from an India-based Network Operations Centre (NOC) or whether on-site personnel are mandatory for all deployments.	It is preferred to have one local SPOC for Department/ELCOT co-ordination. SPOC can co-ordinate managed service offering
74.	V. Tender Specific Conditions	"CSP should propose security architecture for workloads being migrated to cloud in	Who bears the cost of security architecture design and consultation? Are	Understanding the requirement and proposing the solution is

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	3. Technical Specification Pg.52	consultation with department"	multiple design iterations billable?	scope of MSP/CSP
75.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.52	"Bidder should have defense in depth mechanism to ensure infrastructure resources from external and internal threats"	What specific defense-in-depth components does ELCOT expect (e.g., WAF, IPS, EDR, SIEM integration)?	As per CSP standards.
76.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.52	"In case of security breach, bidder should be able to recover application/data from backup and restore to normal state"	What is the expected RTO for breach recovery? Are CSP costs for breach response/recovery billable or absorbed?	Uncaptured BOQ items are absorbed in the scope of CSP/MSP.
77.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.52	"Bidder should have capability to have safe and secure data in rest and in transit mechanism"	Should CSP provide customer-managed encryption keys (BYOK) or CSP-managed keys?	As per customer requirement

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
78.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.52	"User Administration: Implement IAM with least privilege and multi-factor authentication (MFA)"	Should MFA be mandatory for all users or only administrative/privileged users? Are there allowances for legacy applications that don't support MFA?	As per customer requirement
79.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.53	"Regular vulnerability scanning and penetration testing of systems"	Should Department bear costs for third-party penetration testing? How frequently (quarterly, annually)?	As per customer requirement
80.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.53	"Training: Provide training to officials on request. Infrastructure for offline training provided by Government Department"	What are the maximum training hours/days CSP is obligated to provide free? Are additional training hours billable?	As per customer requirement. It may be noted that this could one time training during onboarding.
81.	Chapter V: Tender Specific	Table: Deductions up to 30% or 100% for outages. Page 57 Clause V.vi:	Conflict Resolution: Please clarify the maximum ceiling on penalty deductions per	Kindly refer 3.6 SLA and Penalties. In case of

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	conditions Pg.55	Maximum cumulative penalty cannot exceed 10% of the work order value...	month. Is the penalty deduction capped at 10% of the monthly invoice value as per Clause V.vi?	Maximum cumulative penalty exceed 10% of the work order value; then Government Department may immediately cancel the work order and forfeit the Performance Security submitted by the bidder
82.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3.6 SLA and Penalties Pg.55	Penalty calculation allows up to 30% of monthly payment but "GST as applicable shall be charged on penalties"	Are penalties calculated on pre-GST or post-GST invoice amounts?	Penalties are derived on basic cost.
83.	V. Tender Specific Conditions	"SLA parameters monitored on monthly basis. If	What constitutes "significant degradation"? What is	Tender condition, as amended by

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	3.6 SLA and Penalties Pg.57	significant degradation occurs and immediate measures not implemented, ELCOT reserves right to terminate contract"	the minimum notice period before termination for non-SLA breach?	latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
84.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3.6 SLA and Penalties Pg.57	"Availability target: >=99.5% for each provisioned resource. Penalty: 10% if <99.5%, 20% if <99.25%, 30% if <99.00%"	Should availability metric exclude scheduled maintenance windows and Department-initiated outages? How is availability calculated (uptime minutes/month)?	Yes. All exclusions not in scope of CSP are applicable.
85.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3.6 SLA and Penalties Pg.57	"99% of Severity 1 incidents resolved within 30 minutes; 95% of Severity 2 within 4 hours; 95% of Severity 3 within 16 hours"	Should "resolution" mean symptom mitigation (e.g., failover) or root cause fix? Is hotfix acceptable for compliance?	Resolution means solving the root cause issue.
86.	V. Tender Specific Conditions	"95% of incidents should receive	Should "response" mean acknowledgment,	Response means acknowledgm

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	3.6 SLA and Penalties Pg.57	response within 15 minutes"	initial investigation, or issue assignment?	ent with possible initial investigation
87.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3.6 SLA and Penalties Pg.57	"VM Uptime SLA of at least 99.5%; Resource scaling within 30 minutes"	For critical Severity 1 incidents, should scaling operations bypass change management approval?	As per CSP terms and policy.
88.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3.6 SLA and Penalties Pg.57	"For Severity 1, 99% of the incidents should be resolved within 30 minutes of problem reporting"	We request the authority to amend this to: "For Severity 1, 99% of the incidents should be resolved within 4 hours of problem reporting."	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
89.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3.6 SLA and Penalties Pg.57	"95% of Severity 2 within 4 hours of problem reporting AND 95% of severity 3 within 16 hours of problem reporting"	We request the authority to amend this to: "95% of Severity 2 within 8 hours of problem reporting AND 95% of severity 3 within 16 hours of problem reporting."	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
90.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.58	Section 3.7.1 states that all listed Virtual Machine packages are Managed Virtual Machines and will be provided with mandatory inclusions without extra cost. The mandatory VM inclusions include Antivirus, entire VM data backup, weekly backup, 30-day backup retention, basic monitoring/dashboard, scheduling, and 30-minute scaling. Annexure 9 separately includes Security, Backup and Antivirus/EDR line items for quotation.	Please amend Section 3.7.1 to state that antivirus/EDR, enterprise backup and backup retention are capabilities/services to be made available and quoted under the Security and Backup categories, rather than mandatory no-extra-cost inclusions bundled with every VM. Alternatively, please clearly specify the minimum no-cost native capability, while allowing enterprise backup, EDR/anti-malware and enhanced security tools to be quoted and billed separately as per the Price Bid.	Bidder may provide the cost as per the public price model and provide clarification as part of the bid.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
91.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg. 58	Provisioning of Cloud Resources	Kindly confirm whether services not currently available in the CSP catalogue but introduced during the contract period under the MeitY empanelment may also be offered under this empanelment.	Yes. MSP/CSP can offer all the cloud services that are MeitY empaneled.
92.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.59	The compute clause permits any supported version of Microsoft Windows Server, RHEL, Oracle Linux, SUSE Linux Enterprise Server, CentOS and Ubuntu. Annexure 9 Part C lists Windows/RHEL/Ubuntu VM rows and includes Oracle Linux only as a non-mandatory line item.	Please confirm that only currently supported OS versions/images are required. Please also confirm that CentOS or any unsupported/EOL OS may be substituted with an equivalent supported Linux distribution such as Oracle Linux, RHEL, Ubuntu or SUSE, and that Oracle Linux may be accepted as an equivalent supported Linux option for	CSP equivalent solution or industry latest available version is acceptable.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			mandatory compute configurations where suitable.	
93.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.59	The Tender defines Equivalent as a product meeting or exceeding the minimum technical, performance and lifecycle requirements specified in the Tender. Section 3.7.1 permits Microsoft Windows Server, Red Hat Enterprise Linux, Oracle Linux, SUSE Linux Enterprise Server, CentOS and Ubuntu. However, Annexure 9 Part C specifically lists RHEL Operating System in S.No. 2, 5, 8, 11, 14, 17, 20, 23, 26, 29, 32, 35,	Please amend all the above RHEL line items in Part C to read "RHEL or Equivalent Enterprise Linux Operating System".	CSP equivalent solution or industry latest available version is acceptable.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		38, 41, 44, 47, 50, 53, 56, 59, 62, 65, 68, 71 and 74.		
94.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.59	Section 3.7.1 and Annexure 9 Part C define compute configurations using vCPU and RAM. The Tender does not specify how CSPs whose compute shapes are commercially/technically expressed in OCPU or another equivalent processor unit should map their offerings to the vCPU-based Tender configurations.	Please add a qualification that, for OCI and other CSPs using OCPU-based compute metering, one OCPU shall be treated as equivalent to two vCPUs for applicable x86 compute shapes for the purpose of technical sizing, bid mapping and commercial evaluation. Accordingly, bidders may quote equivalent OCPU-based shapes by mapping the Tender vCPU rows to the corresponding OCPU/RAM configuration.	Bidder may provide the cost/tech spec as per the public price model and provide clarification as part of the bid.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
95.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.59	"Mandatory: Processor minimum frequency 2.0 GHz or higher"	Are Arm-based processors (e.g., AWS Graviton) acceptable, or only x86 architecture?	If there are different variants; Bidder may provide the details of the same as part of financial bid.pdf
96.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3.7 Provisioning of Cloud resources Pg.59	Mandatory requirement of Virtual Machine	We request the authority to remove "Oracle Linux" from the list of mandatory operating systems to be provided as a minimum inclusion.	Equivalent or higher can be proposed. If bidder doesn't support then same can left out from quoting
97.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specifications Pg.60	Automated horizontal scaling is required; resource scaling should be completed within 30 minutes.	Please clarify whether the 30-minute turnaround applies to manual vertical scaling, horizontal auto-scaling, or both. Kindly define measurement start/end points and exclusions caused by	Applies to horizontal auto scaling

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			OS/application readiness.	
98.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.60	"Backup must be taken at least every week; retained for at least 30 days"	Should backup frequency be configurable per Department needs (daily, weekly, etc.)? Are RPO/RTO SLAs defined for backup recovery?	As per customer requirement
99.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.60	"Auto scaling: Ability to scale horizontally without bringing VM down"	Should auto-scaling preserve active connections/sessions during scaling, or is connection reset acceptable?	As per customer requirement
100.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.60	"Scheduling features: Auto start/auto shutdown without manual intervention"	Should scheduling include day-of-week or time-based rules, or only simple daily schedules?	As per customer requirement
101.	V. Tender Specific Conditions	Automatic horizontal scaling shall be supported.	Kindly clarify whether autoscaling through orchestration,	Yes. Equivalent or

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	3. Technical Specifications Pg.60		infrastructure automation or Kubernetes-based scaling will satisfy this requirement.	higher can be proposed.
102.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.61	The Tender defines Equivalent as a product meeting or exceeding the minimum technical, performance and lifecycle requirements specified in the tender. Clause 3.7.2(c) states that File Storage should span across multiple availability zone and that backup/archival storage and encryption should be available.	Please confirm that an equivalent architecture will be accepted for file storage where a CSP provides high availability, durability, backup, encryption and/or cross-region replication but does not expose a native file-storage service spanning multiple availability zones in the exact manner stated. Please also confirm the minimum evidence required to establish equivalence.	Each CSP have there own feature. Tender captures the usual requirements and CSPs can provide their equivalent solution.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
103.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.61	Object Storage must provide strong read after-write consistency, unlimited-scale storage, intelligent data tiering based on data use, built-in capability to analyze storage access patterns, versioning and MFA for deletion, and integration with HSM/key-management solutions. File Storage should span across multiple availability zones. Section 3.7.5(d) requires FIPS-compliant HSM-related services.	Please confirm that CSP-native equivalent features will be accepted for object and file storage, including lifecycle policies, storage classes/tiering, object versioning/retention/immutability, access logs/analytics, encryption with KMS or HSM-backed keys, cross-availability-domain or cross-region replication, backup and archival services. Please confirm that exact feature names such as "intelligent data tier" or "MFA for deletion" are not mandatory where equivalent security, durability and governance outcomes are met.	Clarified already. CSP equivalent solution is acceptable.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
104.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	EDR	Is supplier expected to propose antivirus solution and provide managed services in target state, if so is AV solution limited to servers or is it configured on end point devices (Laptop & Desktops) as well? What is the count of servers and Endpoints implemented with AV solution?	CSP/MSP may have the required features. Required metrics will be finalized as per end user requirements. Solution proposed would be implemented in Cloud infrastructure of end user maintained by CSP. This is not applicable to enduser laptops/desktops.
105.	V. Tender Specific Conditions	HSM/KMS	We understand that Supplier is expected to provide a Hardware Security Module(HSM)/Key	CSP/MSP may have the required features. Required

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	3. Technical Specification Pg.61		Management Solution KMS platform is to be proposed as part of the managed services scope. Could you please confirm the expected volumetric requirements, including Transaction per Seconds (TPS)?, key usage, number of integrating applications/databases, No of Vcenter or VM's instances and also provide volumetrics for Data Masking and Certificate Lifecycle Management (CLM) to help us size the solution appropriately?	metrics will be finalized as per end user requirements.
106.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification	"Antivirus; Identity & Access Management; Encryption; System logs; MFA;	Are these services included in VM pricing or separately chargeable? Are they CSP-native or can	Every CSP has their own modeling. It is requested to quote the price as per

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	Pg.61	Hardening & Patch Management"	third-party agents be installed?	CSP model and provide clarity in the financial bid.pdf mentioning the inclusion/exclusion.
107.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	"Block Storage: 99.9% SLA, volume snapshot capability"	Should CSP provide unlimited snapshots or are there limits on snapshot count/retention?	As per customer requirement
108.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	"Object Storage: Unlimited scale storage, intelligent data tiering, MFA for deletion"	Should Department provide MFA credentials or CSP manages MFA? What is approval process for deletion?	As per customer requirement

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
109.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	"Object Storage: Integration with HSM and key management solutions"	Should HSM be customer-managed or CSP-managed? Is HSM available as a separate service line item?	As per customer requirement
110.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	"File Storage should span across multiple availability zones"	For government workloads requiring data residency in specific states, can File Storage be geo-restricted to specific availability zones?	Data residency is expected within India. There is no mention on specific state.
111.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	"Archival Storage available; Retrieval of Archival Storage available"	What is the RTO for archival storage retrieval? Are retrieval costs separate from storage costs?	Every CSP has their own modeling. It is requested to quote the price as per CSP model and provide clarity in the financial bid.pdf mentioning the

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
				inclusion/exclusion.
112.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	"Managed Database: Minimum 50 GB HDD or 50 GB SSD storage inclusion"	Are backups counted against the 50 GB inclusion or provided separately? What is the max database size supported?	Kindly refer BoQ for items. Every CSP has their own modeling. It is requested to quote the price as per CSP model and provide clarity in the financial bid.pdf mentioning the inclusion/exclusion.
113.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	"Automated failover, backup & recovery, isolation & security, scaling, automated patching"	For production databases, should blue-green deployments be supported for zero-downtime patching?	As per customer requirement

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
114.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	"CSP shall provide transparent view of database activities managed by them"	Should CSP provide access to database transaction logs, query performance insights, and security audit logs?	CSP to provide performance insights.
115.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.61	"Database licenses to Government Organizations which they can use in that particular CSP's Cloud environment"	Is the license model BYOL (Bring Your Own License) or does CSP provide licenses? What happens if Department wants to migrate licensed databases to another CSP?	Kindly refer BoQ for items. Every CSP has their own modeling. It is requested to quote the price as per CSP model and provide clarity in the financial bid.pdf mentioning the inclusion/exclusion.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
116.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.62	"Application Load Balancer, Network Load Balancer, WAF available; cost will be discovered"	Should load balancers include auto-scaling rules, health checks, and traffic distribution policies?	Kindly refer BoQ for items. Every CSP has their own modeling. It is requested to quote the price as per CSP model and provide clarity in the financial bid.pdf mentioning the inclusion/exclusion.
117.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.62	"WAF must provide protection against OWASP top ten risks"	Should WAF rules be managed by CSP or Department? How frequently are WAF rules updated for emerging threats?	Department may provide requirement of WAF. It is in scope of CSP/MSP to ensure WAF rule updation, etc.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
118.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.62	"CDN service: Monthly price per GB of Outbound Data Transfer will be discovered"	Should CDN include origin shielding, cache purging APIs, and real-time analytics?	Kindly refer BoQ for items. Every CSP has their own modeling. It is requested to quote the price as per CSP model and provide clarity in the financial bid.pdf mentioning the inclusion/exclusion.
119.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.62	"MPLS connectivity: Port Charges will be discovered; User Department to pay network provider separately"	Should CSP coordinate with network provider or is Department responsible for end-to-end MPLS setup?	CSP to take care of connectivity reaching their respective DCs. Others will be in Department scope.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
120.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.62	Clause 3.5(f)(iii) requires regular vulnerability scanning and penetration testing of systems. Clause 3.7.5 requires native security services including vulnerability assessment and security monitoring. Annexure 9 includes VAPT as a service in Part A and Vulnerability Assessment as service in Part C.	Please confirm that vulnerability assessment and penetration testing will be performed only within the approved scope, windows and methods permitted by the underlying CSP security-testing policy and with prior approvals where required. Please clarify whether VAPT is mandatory for all workloads or only when procured/ordered by the department.	End user Department may chose based on their requirement.
121.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.62	Section 3.7.5 states that the CSP must provide native services for security, including identity/access management, AI-powered threat	Please amend "CSP must provide native services for security" to allow CSP-native, CSP-managed, marketplace, partner-managed or equivalent services, provided the	Clarified already. CSP equivalent solution is acceptable.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		detection, unified security/compliance dashboard, vulnerability assessment, API/user activity tracking, firewall/WAF/DDoS, sensitive data discovery, FIPS-compliant HSM, certificate/secrets management, disaster recovery and ransomware recovery. Annexure 9 contains corresponding security line items.	bidder remains responsible for delivery under the work order. Please also confirm that FIPS 140-2 Level 3, FIPS 140-3 Level 3 or equivalent HSM/KMS certification will be acceptable, and that HSM/key backup, ransomware recovery and disaster recovery may be demonstrated through the CSP's standard key-resilience, backup, DR and recovery architecture rather than through separately named services.	
122.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 3. Technical Specifications Pg.63	Section 3.7.6 requires Basic Support with 24x7 access to email, chat and phone support and 1-hour response	Please confirm that CSP support delivered through the CSP's standard support portal/service-request process, email/phone	Clarified already. CSP equivalent solution is acceptable.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		for service/system outage, and Enterprise Support with 15-minute response for business-critical system outage. Section 3.6 measures response and resolution from ticket logging. Annexure 9 includes Basic Support Service and Enterprise Support Services as quoted items.	support and the MSP's 24x7 helpdesk/escalation matrix will satisfy the support-channel requirement, even where chat is not available for every service or severity. Please align response, restoration and resolution obligations with the selected CSP support plan, MSP support scope and severity definitions in the work order.	
123.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.63	"AI Powered Threat Detection Service; Unified Security Dashboard; Vulnerability Assessment"	Should AI-based threat detection be tuned for Government workload patterns or use generic threat models?	Kindly refer BoQ for items. Every CSP has their own modeling. It is requested to quote the price as per CSP model and provide

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
				clarity in the financial bid.pdf mentioning the inclusion/exclusion.
124.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 3. Technical Specification Pg.63	"HSM should support FIPS 140-2 Level 3; Managed backup service for HSM Cluster"	Should HSM backups be encrypted and stored separately for disaster recovery? Are HSM costs separate from encryption service costs?	Kindly refer BoQ for items. Every CSP has their own modeling. It is requested to quote the price as per CSP model and provide clarity in the financial bid.pdf mentioning the inclusion/exclusion.
125.	V. Tender Specific Conditions	"Ransomware Recovery: Fast and Automated Control	Should Department define allowable recovery point	CSP shall have basic functionality.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	3. Technical Specification Pg.63	for Disaster Recovery and Ransomware Recovery"	objectives (RPO) for ransomware scenarios, or does CSP set defaults?	RTO and RPO would be defined based on individual Department requirement
126.	**V. Tender Specific Conditions** 3. Technical Specifications Pg.63	FIPS compliant fully managed scalable HSM supporting FIPS 140-2 Level 3.	Kindly clarify whether an OEM-certified managed HSM service integrated with the cloud platform shall be considered compliant, or whether bidders are expected to own and operate dedicated HSM appliances.	Yes. Equivalent or higher can be proposed.
127.	V. Tender Specific Conditions - 5. Evaluation Process Pg.66	The mandatory pre-requisite states that only CSPs currently empaneled with MeitY and only CSP services/DCs empaneled with MeitY are eligible. Clause 5(c) states that CSP services mentioned in	Please clarify that a CSP service will be treated as eligible where the service is covered under the relevant MeitY-empaneled CSP service category and is available from a MeitY-empaneled India data-center/region, even if	Services empaneled through this tender shall be empaneled under MeitY.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		Annexure 7 should have list prices available in the public domain. Annexure 7 requires the CSP to confirm that offered cloud service offerings are empaneled by MeitY and available in MeitY-empaneled data centers.	the CSP public service name, SKU, URL or pricing meter differs from the wording in the Tender. Please also clarify whether newly launched CSP services or service enhancements after MeitY empanelment may be quoted once available in the MeitY-empaneled India region, or only after formal MeitY inclusion/update.	
128.	V. Tender Specific Conditions – 5. Evaluation Process Pg.67	Clause 5(k) states that for Part A and Part C, the bidder quoting the highest average discount percentage of mandatory services will be declared H1 against a particular CSP, and bidder(s) who have quoted for	Please clarify the exact H1/L1 matching process after opening of the commercial bid. Specifically, please confirm whether the H1 commercial bid/price will be disclosed to other bidders for matching purposes; whether the	H1/L1 will be ranked within CSPs. MSPs matching the H1/L1 discount/prices will be empaneled.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		that CSP and are ready to match the H1 price for that CSP would be empaneled. Clause 5(l) provides a similar matching process for Part B L1 percentage.	disclosure will be line-item price level; the mode of communication; the time period allowed to such bidders to submit matching confirmation;	
129.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 5. Evaluation Process Pg.67	Part B: Bidder quoting the lowest % would be declared as L1 against particular CSP.	Clarification on Evaluation: Please clarify whether Part A/C (Cloud Discount) and Part B (Managed Services %) are evaluated independently or combined to determine the final empaneled bidder per CSP. If evaluated independently, what happens if Bidder 1 is H1 in Part A but L2 in Part B?	There is no combined evaluation. Each part will be evaluated separately. Bidder may note that managed services is a optional item that an end user can procure. ELCOT would take up all the best efforts to match the

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
				L1/H1 pricing/discount under each category.
130.	V. Tender Specific Conditions 7. Payment Schedule Pg.68	h) The preferred payment cycle shall be indicated by the bidder - Monthly, quarterly and annual payment models are allowed. However, for operational convenience, while placing orders, ELCOT may give preference to the bidders who have given quarterly or annual payment options.	Bidder requests the following addition: ELCOT agrees to pay bidder invoices within thirty days of receipt.	Work order would be issued by end user department. Invoices would be paid the end user department directly.
131.	Annexure – 2 Bank Guarantee Format Pg.73	Annexure – 2 Bank Guarantee Format	Bidder requests the following addition: Bank's liability shall stand automatically discharged unless a claim in writing is	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			lodged with the Bank within the period stated in the BG including the extended period. The BG will automatically be deemed to expire on the date of expiry of the BG as mentioned in the agreement even if the physical copy has not been returned to us.	latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
132.	Annexure – 3 Power of Attorney Pg.75	Annexure – 3 Power of Attorney	Bidder requests the following: Please accept Power of Attorney in the bidder's own format	Acceptable. As a long it address the terms and condition available in existing format.
133.	V. Tender Specific Conditions Annexure - 5 Letter of Undertaking	B. Declaration Regarding Blacklisting / Debarment I/We hereby solemnly declare	Annexure - 5 Letter of Undertaking B. Declaration Regarding Blacklisting / Debarment I/We hereby solemnly	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
	Pg.81	and confirm that: a) Neither I/We nor any of our OEMs have been blacklisted, debarred, or declared ineligible for corrupt, fraudulent, or unethical practices by any State Government, Central Government, Public Sector Undertaking, Statutory Board, or Local Body during the last three (3) years preceding the date of submission of this bid. b) In the event of any information or declaration furnished herein being found to be false, misleading, or	declare and confirm that: We have not been blacklisted, debarred, or declared ineligible for corrupt, fraudulent, or unethical practices by any State Government, Central Government, Public Sector Undertaking, Statutory Board, or Local Body during the last three (3) years preceding the date of submission of this bid, which shall have material adverse impact in rendering services under this contract. b) In the event of any information or declaration furnished herein being found to be false, misleading, or suppressed, ELCOT	latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		suppressed, ELCOT shall have the right to reject the bid or terminate the contract forthwith without any compensation, in addition to initiating appropriate legal or penal action. C. Declaration of No Conflict of Interest a) I/We hereby declare that there exists no actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest on our part arising out of any past, present, or proposed contracts, engagements, or affiliations with any Department, Agency, or Organization of the	shall have the right to reject the bid or terminate the contract forthwith without any compensation, in addition to initiating appropriate legal or penal action. V. Tender Specific Conditions Annexure - 5 Letter of Undertaking B. Declaration Regarding Blacklisting / Debarment I/We hereby solemnly declare and confirm that: a) Neither I/We nor any of our OEMs must have not been blacklisted, debarred, or declared ineligible for corrupt, fraudulent, or unethical practices by any State Government, Central Government, Public	

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		State Government. b) I/We undertake to immediately disclose any conflict of interest that may arise during the execution of the contract. c) I/We agree to indemnify and hold harmless ELCOT and/or the End User against all losses, damages, claims, costs, expenses, and liabilities (including reasonable legal and professional fees on a reimbursement basis) arising out of any such conflict of interest.	Sector Undertaking, Statutory Board, or Local Body during the last three (3) years preceding the date of submission of this bid, which shall have material adverse impact in rendering services under this contract. b) In the event of any information or declaration furnished herein being found to be false, misleading, or suppressed, ELCOT shall have the right to reject the bid or terminate the contract forthwith without any compensation, in addition to initiating appropriate legal or penal action. C. Declaration of No Conflict of Interest	

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			a) I/We hereby state that there exists no actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest on our part arising out of any past, present, or proposed contracts, engagements, or affiliations with any Department, Agency, or Organization of the State Government, which shall have material adverse impact in rendering services under this contract. b) We undertake to immediately disclose any conflict of interest that may arise during the execution of the contract. c) We agree to indemnify ELCOT against all losses,	

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			damages, claims, costs, expenses, and liabilities (including reasonable legal and professional fees on a reimbursement basis) arising out of any such conflict of interest if that causes an adverse material impact in rendering services under the contract.	
134.	Annexure 7 Technical Compliance Pg.86	Clause 3.1(a) states that all terms and conditions of the CSP's empanelment with MeitY are automatically applicable. Clauses 3.4 and 3.5 cover Migration Services and Cloud Managed Services. Annexure 7 is titled Technical Compliance and states: "I/We am/are the Cloud	Please amend Annexure 7 to require the CSP to certify/sign only CSP-native and MeitY-empaneled cloud services/data-center categories. For services delivered by the bidder/MSP, such as migration, cloud managed services, helpdesk, VAPT/professional services and implementation	CSP endorsement is limited to CSPs own services. Over and above services would be certified by MSP.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		Service Provider" and that all offered cloud service offerings listed are MeitY-empaneled and available in MeitY-empaneled data centers. Annexure 7 also lists Migration Services and Cloud Managed Services and requires signature of the CSP.	support, please allow the bidder/MSP to certify compliance, with CSP endorsement limited to underlying cloud platform availability. Where delivery is shared between CSP platform and MSP services, please permit joint/complementary compliance.	
135.	Annexure 9 Pg.91	Category: Co-location: 42 U rack with 5KVA power, space, cooling (Items 136–138)	Public Cloud Exemption: Please confirm that Co-location items (136–138) are optional / non-mandatory for hyperscaler public cloud MSPs (AWS/Azure/GCP/OCI) who deliver cloud services without physical rack rentals.	Optional service only.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
136.	Annexure 9 Pg.93	Part B Managed Services: % Of Monthly Bill of Cloud Services (Post Discount quoted by bidder on the CSP pricing)	Minimum Floor Fee: For small departmental workloads with very low monthly cloud bills, a flat percentage may not cover basic 24x7 operational helpdesk and SLA risks. Can ELCOT establish a minimum monthly floor fee per work order (e.g., ₹X/month or actual % fee, whichever is higher)?	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
137.	Annexure 9 Pg.93	Percentage of monthly bill (Single Flat Quote)	Slab-Based Quote Provision: Can bidders be allowed to quote slab-based percentages based on monthly cloud spend ranges (e.g., up to ₹5L, ₹5L–₹20L, >₹20L) rather than a single uniform flat percentage across all order sizes?	MSP/CSP may provide minimum % in BOQ. MSP/CSP may submit any additional discount as part of financial bid.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
138.	Annexure – 9 Price Bid PART-C (Itemized discount %) Pg.97	1. 4 vCPU and 4GB RAM + Windows Operating System Count 2. 4 vCPU and 4GB RAM + RHEL Operating System Count 3. 4 vCPU and 4GB RAM + Ubuntu Operating System	The RFP specifies a VM configuration of 4 vCPU × 4 GB RAM. However, this configuration is not available in Microsoft Azure. We request the department to allow the nearest equivalent or higher configuration, i.e., 4 vCPU × 8 GB RAM, or equivalent configurations offered by other cloud service providers, without treating it as a deviation.	Nearest equivalent or higher configuration can be provided by the bidder.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
139.	Annexure – 9 Price Bid PART-C (Itemized discount %) Pg.97	12 vCPU VM Configurations	The RFP specifies VM configurations with 12 vCPU and memory sizes of 24 GB, 48 GB, and 96 GB RAM. However, these exact VM configurations are not available in Microsoft Azure. We request the department to confirm whether the nearest equivalent or higher Azure VM configuration (or equivalent configurations offered by other cloud service providers) will be considered compliant without being treated as a deviation.	Nearest equivalent or higher configuration can be provided by the bidder.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
140.	Annexure – 9 Price Bid PART-C (Itemized discount %) Pg.97	16 vCPU / 48 GB RAM Configuration	The RFP specifies a VM configuration of 16 vCPU with 48 GB RAM. However, this exact configuration is not available in Microsoft Azure. We request the department to confirm whether the nearest equivalent or higher Azure VM configuration (or equivalent configurations offered by other cloud service providers) may be considered compliant without being treated as a deviation.	Nearest equivalent or higher configuration can be provided by the bidder.
141.	Annexure – 9 Price Bid PART-C (Itemized discount %) Pg.98	24 vCPU VM Configurations	The RFP specifies 24 vCPU VM configurations with required memory sizes that are not available in Microsoft Azure. Azure provides 24	Nearest equivalent or higher configuration can be provided by the bidder.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			vCPU VM sizes only with higher memory configurations than those specified in the RFP. We request the department to kindly confirm whether bidders may propose the nearest equivalent or higher memory VM configuration available in Azure (or equivalent configurations offered by other cloud service providers) without being treated as a deviation.	
142.	Annexure – 9 Price Bid PART-C (Itemized discount %) Pg.100	MySQL Edition	The RFP specifies MySQL under Items 79–83; however, it does not clarify IAAS or PAAS. We request the department to kindly	Bidder may quote for IAAS. If bidder support PAAS; then same can be provided on financial bid pdf document

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			clarify whether the requirement is for MySQL PaaS or MySQL Community Edition deployed on a Virtual Machine (IaaS).	as additional item.
143.	Annexure – 9 Price Bid PART-C (Itemized discount %) Pg.100	Redis Cache Sizing	Please specify the size of redis cache (MB/GB)	The RAM capacities mentioned against Items 89 to 91 shall be treated as the required Redis cache capacity. Bidder may provide other less combination as part of financial bid pdf document as additional item.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
144.	Annexure – 9 Price Bid PART-C (Itemized discount %) Pg.101	Kubernetes Master and Worker Nodes	The BOQ includes a single pricing field for the Kubernetes Cluster. However, a Kubernetes cluster consists of Master (Control Plane) nodes and Worker Nodes, which have different VM configurations and associated costs. We request the department to kindly clarify whether bidders should provide a combined cost covering both Master and Worker Nodes in the single BOQ line item, or quote the Master and Worker Nodes separately, if permitted.	Bidder may provide the cost/tech spec as per the public price model in BoQ. Additional items if any can be provided with cost and specification as part of financial bid pdf.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
145.	Annexure – 9 Price Bid PART-C (Itemized discount %) Pg.104	Category: Co-location 1. 42 U rack with 5KVA power, space, cooling Count 2. Additional 1 KVA Count 3. Additional 0.5 KVA Count	Request for clarification ? Kindly confirm whether these services are expected to be quoted as third-party co-location services or if an equivalent cloud-based offering is acceptable.	Optional Co-location service.
146.	General Query	Provisioning of Cloud resources	Please clarify If environment-specific requirements exist, kindly confirm whether they should be considered separately for sizing and commercial estimation.	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.
147.	General Query	Provisioning of Cloud resources	Please clarify whether the DR site is required to operate in an Active-Active or Active-Passive configuration. Additionally, kindly	Detailed requirement for DR would vary based on end user requirements.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			confirm the expected compute, storage, and network capacity to be maintained at the DR site, and whether the DR environment should be sized to support the full production workload during failover	
148.	General Query	Provisioning of Cloud resources	Please clarify whether GPU-based infrastructure is envisaged as part of the cloud requirements. If yes, kindly specify the expected use cases, GPU specifications, quantity, and applicable environments (Development, UAT, Production, DR).	Current BoQ doesn't capture GPU based infra. However, bidder may add it as additional items with specs and cost in financial bid.pdf



S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
149.	General Query		Please confirm whether Cloud Services (CSP), Managed Services (MSP), Migration Services, Backup Services, and DR Services may be availed independently by the department, or whether they are expected to be procured as an integrated offering	Only Managed Services is optional for Department.
150.	General Query	ALB, NLB, VPN, firewall, public IP and WAF should be available	Please define mandatory sizing for firewall, WAF, DDoS, load balancer and VPN	CSP/MSP may define their metrics based on their offering.
151.	General Query	IAM, PAM,MFA	Is supplier expected to propose a new IAM solution and provide managed services support. Please provide details(Count of users, Count of servers,etc)	CSP/MSP may have the required features. Required metrics will be finalized as

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			Please provide Number of admin users will be using IAM RBAC, MFA, SSO solution? MFA is like Hardware Token Type?	per end user requirements.
152.	General Query	DLP	Is supplier expected to propose a new please confirm Which network access points and communication channels (e.g., internet egress, email, SaaS applications, VPN, remote access, and internal network segments) should be covered by the proposed DLP policy enforcement framework?	CSP/MSP may have the required features. Required metrics will be finalized as per end user requirements.
153.	General Query	VAPT	We understand that Supplier is expected to provide a Vulnerability Assessment & penetration-testing solution as part of the	CSP/MSP may have the required features. Required metrics will be

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			scope, or if the Supplier should engage a third-party agency to perform penetration testing on the target environment. Additionally, to help us assess the scope and effort, kindly provide the following details: Total number of internal IPs to be included in the vulnerability assessment and penetration testing. Total number of external IPs to be considered for testing. Understanding that testing frequency for both vulnerability assessments and penetration tests to be conduct annually?	finalized as per end user requirements.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
154.	General Query	SSL	Is supplier expected to provide certificates, please provide the number of internal and external certificates required.	CSP/MSP providing certificates is recommended. However, end user may procure themselves also.
155.	General Query	SIEM & SOAR	Does supplier need to propose new SIEM solution and SOC services as part of this opportunity or Is supplier expected to leverage existing SIEM tool for in scope devices integration. If so what is the tool in use and what level of Security monitoring support is expected from supplier (L1,L2, L3). what is the EPS count or GB/day log volume in use for	CSP/MSP may have the required features. Required metrics will be finalized as per end user requirements.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			existing SIEM Solution?	
156.	General Query	Multiple clauses reference "as per Department requirements" but no baseline defaults defined	Should ELCOT provide a template/list of typical requirements or does each Department define independently?	Each Department has independent requirements. There is no baseline requirement.
157.	General Query		Could ELCOT provide an indicative estimate of the expected volume of cloud resources (VMs, Storage, Databases, etc.) to help bidders assess provisioning timelines and operational effort?	It would vary based on the customer requirements.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
158.	General Query		Has ELCOT identified or empaneled the Network Service Provider (ISP/MPLS vendor)? If yes, what is the expected circuit provisioning timeline, and will cloud migration commence only after network connectivity is established?	This will be done based on customer requirement. Connectivity from SDC would be in the scope of ELCOT/customer.
159.	General Query		Could ELCOT clarify whether SIEM/SOC services form part of the MSP scope? If yes, is the MSP expected to provide and manage the SIEM platform or integrate cloud resources with the customer's existing SIEM solution?	SIEM solution is not available with Customer. Based on customer requirement, SIEM services may be required to be provided by CSP.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
160.	General Query		Are Security Incident Response, Threat Hunting, Vulnerability Management, and Security Compliance Monitoring expected as part of the Managed Services scope? If yes, please specify the expected responsibilities and SLA.	Pls refer 3.5 Cloud Managed Services.
161.	General Query		Could ELCOT clarify whether the expected Managed Services support model is Dedicated, Shared, or Hybrid?	Functional scope is provided. CSP may provide the service as per there norms.
162.	General Query		Is the mandatory Data Centre visit applicable even if the bidder provides all required certifications (ISO, PCI-DSS, SOC, etc.) and audit reports?	Optional. Pls refer prior clarifications

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
163.	General Query		Apart from the Price Card/Rate Card, are there any additional commercial or technical deliverables expected as part of the bid submission?	MSP/CSP may add additional services as required, as part of financial bid.pdf
164.	General Query		Could ELCOT clarify the payment timeline applicable to Government Departments after invoice submission under this empanelment?	ELCOT would inform Department/End user for payments within 30 days from invoice as part of SOP
165.	General Query		Will consortium participation between an MSP and a System Integrator be permitted for project-specific opportunities arising under this empanelment?	Tender condition, as amended by latest corrigendum/clarified by latest pre-bid reply, stands good.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
166.	General Query		For projects where infrastructure sizing is finalized by the application vendor or department, will there be a formal validation/acceptance process before SLA obligations become applicable to the MSP?	Yes. Work orders would be issued by Department to MSP/CSP.
167.	General Query		Is backup administration, backup monitoring, and restoration testing included in the Managed Services scope, or will these be separately contracted?	Kindly refer 3.5 Cloud Managed Service
168.	General Query		Could ELCOT clarify whether the Managed Services scope includes OS administration, middleware administration, database administration, patch	Kindly refer 3.5 Cloud Managed Service

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
			management, backup administration, and routine operational activities, or is it limited to cloud infrastructure management?	
169.	General Query		Can MSPs use their own monitoring tools/platforms, subject to Government security and compliance requirements, or is the use of customer-approved monitoring tools mandatory?	Yes. MSPs can use their own monitoring tools/platforms, subject to Government security and compliance requirements
170.	General Query		Is the MSP expected to provide L1/L2/L3 support, or only L2/L3 support with L1 handled by the customer?	As per Tender conditions

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
171.	General Query		Is the MSP expected to support security audits, compliance reporting, and audit evidence collection during the contract period?	As per Tender conditions
172.	General Query		Could ELCOT clarify the expected transition/onboarding period for MSPs, including knowledge transfer, documentation, and baseline environment handover before SLA commencement?	Typically, a one-month period. Can vary based on customer requirements.
173.	Annexure 5-Letter of undertaking	Our Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) / Security Deposit (SD) has not been forfeited by any Government authority or PSU during the last three (3) years due to	Request for amendment of the clause as below I/We hereby declare and certify that: Our Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) / Security Deposit (SD) has not been forfeited by ELCOT during the	Kindly refer to corrigendum.

S. No	Title of clause	Existing clause	Query/Amendment requested	Response
		non-performance or non-compliance.	last three (3) years due to non-performance or non-compliance. Or I/We hereby declare and certify that: Our Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) / Security Deposit (SD) has not been forfeited by any authority/department or PSU under Government of Tamil Nadu during the last three (3) years due to non-performance or non-compliance.	

GENERAL MANAGER (PROCUREMENT), ELCOT/
TENDER INVITING AUTHORITY



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